

Sources Sought Notice No. 2026029331

“Noxious Weed and Vegetation Control”

March 24, 2026

Background:

The National Laboratory of the Rockies (NLR) is a national laboratory owned by the U.S. Department of Energy (DOE). NLR is the only federal laboratory dedicated to research, development, commercialization, and deployment of renewable energy and energy efficiency technologies. NLR is managed and operated for DOE’s Office of Critical Minerals and Energy Innovation by The Alliance for Energy Innovation (Alliance), the “M&O Contractor”.

Objective:

The objective of this Sources Sought is to identify potential subcontracting companies that are qualified and capable of meeting the project objectives. The project objective, at a high level, is to provide Noxious Weed and Vegetation Control.

Project Details:

In the event a solicitation is released, NLR is seeking information from sources that may be capable of providing a solution that meets or exceeds the following minimum capabilities:

- a. Subcontractor is responsible for decreasing the overall presence of noxious weeds across the site and managing vegetation around decorative rock areas and fire breaks through the application of pesticides. Subcontractor shall provide recommendations that offer approaches and remedies specific to plant species to the NLR Subject Matter Expert (SME) for review and approval.
- b. Subcontractor shall comply with all laws, regulations, policies, procedures and guidelines set forth by NLR, the State of Colorado and the Federal Government.
- c. Pesticides shall be applied by State licensed applicators in accordance with the requirements described on the pesticide label.
- d. Subcontractor shall maintain a Commercial Applicator License and register with the Colorado Department of Agriculture. A copy of the applicator’s license shall be provided to the Technical Monitor and Environmental, Safety, Health, Quality (ESHQ) POC prior to commencing herbicide treatment.
- e. Commercial Applicator
 - a. All Subcontractor employees working on-site as Certified Herbicide Applicators shall be Colorado certified with instruction in the following categories: Category 107: Rangeland Pest Control, Category 108: Aquatic Pest Control, Category 109: Industrial and Right-of-Way Weed Control, Category 206: Turf Pest Control, Category 207: Ornamental Pest Control, Category 304: Residential/Commercial Pest Control.
 - b. At a minimum, Subcontractor shall provide at least one primary and one secondary Certified Applicator.

- c. The Certified Applicator shall meet with the NLR Technical SME for Noxious Weed Management to review the Annual Weed Management Plan and assist with implementation of the plan.
 - d. This team member must understand the principles of integrated weed management including planning, prevention, inventory and monitoring, as well as the full range of control techniques.
 - e. Required skills include the ability to identify invasive plant species, implement a variety of chemical methods to control invasive plants.
- f. The Subcontractor shall comply with all requirements of Colorado Air Pollution Control Division (APCD) Regulation No. 29. Per this requirement, NLR strongly prefers the use of electric equipment. See the Scope of Work for further details.
- g. At all times there must be one individual that has the ability to transport individuals and equipment around the sites.

Request Details:

The Alliance intends to competitively solicit for Noxious Weed and Vegetation Control, dependent upon the volume of qualified responses received.

Step 1 - Sourcing (SSN): Parties that meet the minimum criteria outlined herein are encouraged to submit their capabilities statements. Submitted capabilities statements that meet the Alliance's stated criteria will be considered for inclusion in the source list to receive notice of the planned RFP. The Alliance reserves the right to add additional sources to the source list at its discretion.

Step 2: Qualifying (RFQ): Once the source list is compiled (the Alliance reserves the right to add additional sources to the source list at its discretion), the Alliance will send each qualified source the solicitation document Request for Proposals (RFP). Sources will then be asked to submit in accordance with that formal solicitation document. The Alliance will then evaluate the submitted qualifications against the selection criteria.

Period of Performance: This project is anticipated to have a base period of performance totaling twelve (12) months or 365 days, plus four one-year option periods totaling twelve (12) months of 365 days. The total Period of Performance, if all options are exercised, shall not exceed sixty (60) months.

Anticipated Lead/Delivery Time: The Alliance program anticipates the lead/delivery time to be 08/01/2026.

Location of Work to be Performed: Offerors shall be able to demonstrate their capability to perform in these locations:

National Laboratory of the Rockies (NLR)
South Table Mountain Campus (STM)
15013 Denver West Parkway
Golden, CO 80401

National Laboratory of the Rockies (NLR)
Flatirons Campus (FC)
19001 W. 119th Ave
Arvada, CO 80007

National Laboratory of the Rockies (NLR)
South Table Mountain Energy Park (STEP)
15445 S. Golden Road
Golden, CO 80401

Submission Requirements:

For companies interested in competing for the “Noxious Weed and Vegetation Control” RFP, please submit the following to Lee Brown at Lee.Brown@NLR.gov on or before 5:00 p.m. (MST), 04/02/2026. Your submission response is limited to 2-5 pages:

1. Company Name, Address, and Company URL (include bona-fide location as stated above).
2. Point of Contact Information (Email, Direct Phone Number).
3. Completed Notice of Intent to Attend Conference Form.
4. Vendor must demonstrate a local business presence in the Denver Metropolitan area.
5. Company’s Capability Statement that provides a narrative of the Offeror’s expertise with projects of similar scope, size, and complexity as identified below:

Equipment/Services Capability: Alliance is seeking a subcontractor that has demonstrated success with similar projects, has experience with federally funded projects, is knowledgeable with challenging schedules on project delivery, and is well versed and skilled in effectively integrating with all project team stakeholders.

Please complete the following table.

1	Noxious Weed Control Capabilities	Experience: Yes/No	Years Experience (if applicable)
---	-----------------------------------	-----------------------	-------------------------------------

1.1			
1.2			
1.3			
1.4			
1.5			

2	Vegetation Control Capabilities	Experience: Yes/No	Years Experience (if applicable)
2.1			
2.2			
2.3			

Disclaimer: Responding to this request identifies your company as an interested candidate only. Your submittal is not in response to a Request for Proposals (RFP). This is an SSN, not a Request for Proposal. Verbal replies will not be accepted. All inquiries must be in writing via email. Project related questions will not be entertained at this point in the procurement process. This document represents a market research effort. Any costs associated with the development of a response to this request will not be reimbursed by NLR and submission does not guarantee or otherwise promise inclusion in any forthcoming RFP. In the event a solicitation results from this SSN, NLR reserves the right to set aside in total or in part any resultant award. Please visit the SAM website at <https://sam.gov/content/entity-registration> for instructions on how to register.